REG-02 | Therapist only - all age groups

Understanding emotion, need and context

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Describe an event, feeling and response, and explore what matters to the person in this context. Treat a need as a hypothesis to explore, not an automatic conclusion; distinguish emotional difficulty from actual harm or threat.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

Do not interpret all anger as a problem within the person or assume a threat is only a feeling. Assess safety, harm, pain or significant changes before practice. Understandable emotions do not justify harming others.

Reusing existing material

REG-01 and Core-02 identify signs and links between an event and response. Use an existing description; here expand to needs, environmental conditions and questions still requiring exploration.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: Dana is angry when interrupted. She notices that finishing what she wants to say matters to her; they explore whether this is a misunderstanding, a recurring pattern or a situation needing support.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

What happened, and what were the background conditions?

2 | Question for discussion

What emotion and response did I identify without judging them?

3 | Question for discussion

What need or important concern might be connected?

4 | Question for discussion

What is known about the situation's safety, and what needs assessment?

5 | Question for discussion

What response or support would address the need and context?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

If finding an emotion word is difficult, a sensation or action description is enough. Do not impose an explanation of a need; safety does not depend on successfully identifying an emotion.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

Choose an emotion word, drawing or body sign. Explaining why is optional; the adult must explore harm and help even when the child is angry.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Explore power differences, belonging and fairness. Do not use the sheet to dismiss objections or demand private disclosures.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Explore pain, fatigue, workload and possible discrimination. Needs may be personal, interpersonal or environmental.

OA | Older adults

Respect varied forms of expression without attributing anger to age. Ask about comfort, hearing or pain when relevant, not as an assumption.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

Choose a safe, suitable opportunity with the person, or use only a fictional conversation in the session. Do not provoke anger or create conflict to complete the sheet. Skipping, stopping and seeking help are options. Harm and threats need an appropriate response before communication practice.

At the next session

Compare the hypothesis with the person's experience. Distinguish understanding a feeling from approving every action; explore changes in context, not only within the person.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.nhs.uk/mental-health/feelings-symptoms-behaviours/feelings-and-symptoms/anger/

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